Sources for the political writing samples

Aditya Totade · facts checked 11 October 2026 (pieces 1–3) and 17 October 2026 (piece 4). Each factual claim in the four pieces, with the report it came from. Interpretations and opinions in the pieces are the author's own and are not listed here.

Mumbai Does Not Need More Civic Spectacle. It Needs a BMC That Can Be Measured.

FACT USED IN THE PIECE	SOURCE
₹25,000 per instance on C&D vehicles without active/authorised tracking (VTMS) and on sites not registered on the MDCTS portal; from Monday; circular to wards; air quality worsening post-monsoon	Moneycontrol, 11 Oct 2026 *"BMC cracks down on construction waste violations…" (citing Indian Express)* www.moneycontrol.com
Same, original	Indian Express, 11 Oct 2026 *"Rs 25,000 fine from Monday: BMC goes after construction waste trucks as Mumbai's air worsens"* indianexpress.com
Fine effective 12 Oct	Free Press Journal, 10–11 Oct 2026 *"Mumbai: BMC to impose ₹25,000 fine…"* www.freepressjournal.in
~8,000 tonnes/day generated; ~1,200 TPD processed ("nearly 85% unprocessed")	FPJ, 20 Aug 2026 *"BMC Seeks Private Partners To Add 2,000 TPD C&D Waste Processing Capacity"* www.freepressjournal.in
Five years ago the city generated only ~1,200–1,300 TPD	ETV Bharat, ~23 May 2026 *"Construction activities in Mumbai are generating…"* www.etvbharat.com
Drivers: redevelopment, Metro construction, road concretisation	Times of India *"BMC disposes of 14k tonnes of debris via automated monitoring system in 1 month"* timesofindia.indiatimes.com
BMC invited EOI to add ~2,000 TPD via private partners (EOI window 20–27 Aug)	FPJ, 20 Aug 2026 www.freepressjournal.in
Portal: 220 registrations 24 Aug–9 Oct; 109 from builders/developers; MDCTS launched 24 Aug	Moneycontrol, 11 Oct 2026 *Moneycontrol, 11 Oct 2026 ("data from the civic body")* www.moneycontrol.com
Portal to be linked to building-permission system (AutoDCR) and estimate debris per project	FPJ, 20 Aug 2026 www.freepressjournal.in

19 Sep announcement: 3-month drive from 1 Oct against 39,111 slum structures 14 ft or taller; followed Kurla landslide and Mankhurd collapse	Indian Express, ~19–24 Sep 2026; HT, 2 Oct 2026 *IE explainer; IE 24 Sep; HT 2 Oct* indianexpress.com indianexpress.com
Mumbai has 2,23,150 slum structures; action already taken on 4,584, notices on 611	Times of India, 1 Oct 2026 *"Amid oppn, BMC shelves plan for 14ft+ slum demolition drive"* timesofindia.indiatimes.com
Corporators of BJP, Congress, Sena (UBT) said they weren't consulted; Phanse's "on what basis" question; Khankar wrote to Bhide seeking rollback and cited "nearly 40 per cent" in slums	Indian Express, 24 Sep 2026 *"After 'pedestrian first' row, BMC faces fresh pushback on demolition drive"* indianexpress.com
Bhide on 1 Oct: "No mass action or special drive is planned"; routine action on unsafe multi-storey structures	Times of India, 1 Oct 2026 *TOI, 1 Oct 2026* timesofindia.indiatimes.com
Joint Commissioner (Vigilance) Devendra Singh: "There was no special drive announced"; BMC press note of 19 Sep; opponents had no written assurance	Hindustan Times, 2 Oct 2026 *"On Day 1, confusion rules over BMC's 14-ft slum demolition plan"* www.hindustantimes.com
Bombay HC, 7 Oct: clean South Mumbai/Worli ≠ clean city; Jogeshwari, Malad among worst; BMC to file affidavit on ward-officer assessments; hearing 22 Oct	Moneycontrol, 8 Oct 2026 *"Bombay HC slams BMC over garbage crisis..." (citing NDTV)* www.moneycontrol.com

Maharashtra's Biggest Political Question Is Not Who Wins the Next Contest. It Is Whether the State Can Deliver.

FACT USED IN THE PIECE	SOURCE
Biennial polls Oct 23 for 5 of 78 seats: Aurangabad, Pune, Nagpur Graduates'; Amravati, Pune Teachers'; counting Oct 27	Moneycontrol, ~7 Oct 2026; The Hindu *Moneycontrol/PTI; The Hindu (ECI announcement)* www.moneycontrol.com www.thehindu.com
Nominations closed Tue 6 Oct; 62 candidates filed for Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar Graduates'	Moneycontrol, ~7 Oct 2026; The Hindu *Moneycontrol/PTI* www.moneycontrol.com www.thehindu.com
Withdrawals closed Fri 9 Oct; Chivate (Sena) withdrew in Pune Teachers' after BJP central leadership intervened	Hindustan Times, 10 Oct 2026 *"As nomination withdrawal window for council polls ends, allies set to clash"* www.hindustantimes.com
Nagpur: ex-BJP MLA (Anil Sole) independent vs official candidate (Sudhakar Kohale); Sena (UBT) vs NCP (SP) in Aurangabad/Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar Graduates'	Hindustan Times, 10 Oct 2026 *HT, 10 Oct 2026* www.hindustantimes.com

265 talukas drought-declared in early September after one of the driest monsoons in years ("nearly 74% of the state")	Down To Earth, Oct 2026 *"Maharashtra's water crisis shows why wastewater reuse must move from policy to practice"* www.downtoearth.org.in
5 Oct: min. 10% water cut from 16 Oct in all urban & rural local bodies; El Niño concern; plan to 31 Aug 2027; drinking water first, then livestock/fodder, then irrigation (rabi food grains/fodder first); 10% emergency buffer per dam; joint squads vs illegal extraction; review via guardian ministers and canal advisory committees	Indian Express, 5 Oct 2026 *"Maharashtra orders water cuts from October 16 amid drought, El Nino concerns"* indianexpress.com
Same, corroboration	Times of India, 5 Oct 2026 *"Maharashtra announces 10% water cut from October 16..."* timesofindia.indiatimes.com
611 tankers (15 govt, 596 private) in 10 districts serving 517 villages and 2,147 hamlets; Sambhajinagar division 263; Ahilyanagar 153; Beed 111; Solapur 98	NDTV, ~9 Oct 2026 *"Maharashtra Deploys 611 Water Tankers Amid Drought, Central Team Visits State" (citing Water Supply & Sanitation Dept report)* www.ndtv.com

Strategic Autonomy Is Becoming More Expensive for India. That Is Exactly Why It Matters.

FACT USED IN THE PIECE	SOURCE
5 Oct: Sitharaman said talks hit a "plateau"; more concessions "very, very difficult"; talks since Feb 2025; Greer said last week a deal wasn't imminent; she said US "would want to reduce that imbalance"	Reuters, 5 Oct 2026 *"India, US have reached a plateau in trade talks, Indian finance minister says"* www.reuters.com
India's surplus with US ≈ $34bn in FY2025/26	Reuters, 6 Oct 2026 *"Explainer: Why have India-US trade talks stalled again and what's next?"* www.reuters.com
US Congress passed the Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act; expected to take effect by mid-Oct; tariffs up to 100% possible over Russian-energy purchases	Moneycontrol, 7 Oct 2026; Indian Express, 11 Oct 2026 *"India floats 3-part Russia-Ukraine truce..." ; Indian Express explainer* www.moneycontrol.com indianexpress.com
Trump announced (Fri 9 Oct) a deal for Russia to supply diesel to US/global markets; IE describes "contradictory signals"	11 Oct 2026 *Indian Express explainer (Shubhajit Roy)* www.moneycontrol.com indianexpress.com
Russian crude: >$43bn in 2025; +25% in H1 2026; record share >50% (≈2.47m bpd) in July; ≈1.82m bpd by Sept	11 Oct 2026 *Indian Express explainer* www.moneycontrol.com indianexpress.com

4 Oct: Jaishankar said India has gone "beyond advocacy", "a little more involved"; talks with both Moscow and Kyiv	Indian Express, ~5 Oct 2026 *"We are in talks with both Russia and Ukraine: Jaishankar"* indianexpress.com
Five Indian seafarers died in Black Sea attacks in second half of July; India summoned diplomats of both countries; Indians ≈12% (~1 in 10) of seafarers	11 Oct 2026 *Indian Express explainer* www.moneycontrol.com indianexpress.com
Three-part proposal (halt attacks on energy/critical infrastructure; keep grain & energy moving via Black Sea ports; end strikes on commercial shipping); Jaishankar's 3 Sep Kyiv visit	Moneycontrol, 7 Oct 2026; Indian Express, 11 Oct 2026 *Moneycontrol, 7 Oct 2026* www.moneycontrol.com indianexpress.com
Sybiha (2 Oct): proposals from India, Egypt, Turkey, US; India's "most comprehensive"; Putin: Modi has "very good ideas"	Oct 2026 *Moneycontrol 7 Oct; IE "India proposal to end war most comprehensive, says Ukraine"* indianexpress.com
Ukraine angered by India's Russian purchases	11 Oct 2026 *Indian Express explainer ("much to Ukraine's anger")* www.moneycontrol.com indianexpress.com
Black Sea ports ≈30% of Russian energy flows to India	7 Oct 2026 *Hindustan Times, as reported by Moneycontrol* www.moneycontrol.com indianexpress.com
Jaishankar: grain, fertiliser, fuel concerns are in India's and Global South's interest	Indian Express, Oct 2026 *"When did India begin latest round of talks with Russia, Ukraine?"* indianexpress.com
Rupee down >7% YTD, near record low (all-time low 96.96); oil and bond-yield pressure	Reuters *Reuters, 8 & 10 Oct 2026* www.reuters.com
RBI repo +25bp to 5.5% on 7 Oct, first hike in nearly four years	Reuters *Reuters, 7 Oct 2026* www.reuters.com
10 Oct: special window supplying dollars from reserves to IOC, HPCL, BPCL (from Monday); 20% FX risk reserve on hedging derivatives >$2m; ANZ's Dhiraj Nim: "will show up in a depletion of reserves"	Reuters, 10 Oct 2026 *"India unveils tough curbs on dollar demand to defend rupee"* www.reuters.com
Modi expected to travel to US for G20 summit in December	11 Oct 2026 *Indian Express explainer* www.moneycontrol.com indianexpress.com

Drought, an Exam Leak and Protest Policing: Maharashtra's Three Tests Come Down to Trust

FACT USED IN THE PIECE	SOURCE

Drought declared in 265 of 358 talukas; 40 added on 14 Oct (305 in all)	IANS via Punjab Kesari, 14 Oct 2026; Down To Earth, Oct 2026 english.punjabkesari.com www.downtoearth.org.in
Dam storage 73.54% on 8 Oct (90.55% a year earlier); Marathwada 43.58% (85.86%)	ETV Bharat Marathi, 8 Oct 2026, citing Water Resources Department data (translated) www.etvbharat.com
611 tankers on 9 Oct	NDTV, ~9 Oct 2026 (Water Supply & Sanitation Department report) www.ndtv.com
783 tankers by 15 Oct (one regional count)	Maharashtra Desha, 15 Oct 2026 (single source)
Mahajan: 10% cut in municipal corporations, municipalities and gram panchayats from 16 Oct; "Drinking water will be given the highest priority."; drinking water reserved to 31 Aug 2027	The Hans India, 6 Oct 2026; Indian Express, 5 Oct 2026 www.thehansindia.com indianexpress.com
Pune weekly day without supply; Nagpur Rs 5,000 fine for wasting water	Business Standard, 13 Oct 2026; The Daily Jagran, 13 Oct 2026 www.business-standard.com www.thedailyjagran.com
14 Oct cabinet: Rs 5,000 advance per affected farmer before Diwali from state funds; Fadnavis quote; 3.5 lakh loan-waiver list; GPS on tankers; 16,000+ illegal connections cut; fee waivers; lenders told not to force repayment	IANS via Punjab Kesari, 14 Oct 2026 english.punjabkesari.com
Sunetra Pawar: assistance to follow the central team's recommendations	ANI via Asianet Newsable, 14 Oct 2026 newsable.asianetnews.com
Central team toured eight districts from ~9 Oct	Deccan Chronicle, 11 Oct 2026 www.deccanchronicle.com
Wadettiwar, Patil, Deshmukh and All India Kisan Sabha reactions and quotes; convoys from 26 Oct, Azad Maidan sit-in from 27 Oct	IANS via Punjab Kesari, 14 Oct 2026 english.punjabkesari.com
MPSC drug inspector exam 22 Mar; leak complaints in July; referred to Mumbai Police; recruitment cancelled late Aug	DT Next, Aug 2026 www.dtnext.in
Protest at three Pune sites from 1 Oct; objective vs descriptive pattern; Raj Thackeray quote	ThePrint (PTI), 5 Oct 2026 theprint.in
Fadnavis, 9 Oct: chairman "joined after the leak took place"; Article 317; "turned entirely political"; High Court and "contempt of court" remarks	IANS via Punjab Kesari, 9 Oct 2026 english.punjabkesari.com
Bombay High Court, 7 Oct (Tripathi CJ, Sethna J): quotes; three weeks for recruitment plan and vacancies; 70,000+ posts shown vacant	Sabrang India, 8 Oct 2026 (order text not seen) sabrangindia.in

12 Oct settlement: chairman on leave (quote); committee with Tukaram Mundhe as secretary, two months; Rohit Pawar quote	IANS via The Hans India, 12 Oct 2026 www.thehansindia.com
Committee headed by a retired judge; cases withdrawn; 70,000 posts over three years (Minister Shivendraraje Bhosale)	Moneylife, 12 Oct 2026 www.moneylife.in
Some protesters would accept nothing short of resignation	Careers360, 12 Oct 2026 news.careers360.com
Chairman sworn in 18 Feb 2026	Free Press Journal, 18 Feb 2026 www.freepressjournal.in
Sapkal, Sept: "Taliban" remark (translated from Marathi) and demand that the CM give up Home	Navarashtra, 11 Sep 2026 www.navarashtra.com
Congress demand in May; fast-track court and special public prosecutor	Lokmat Times, 2 May 2026 www.lokmattimes.com
Pune Police: permission refused citing prohibitory orders; notices to 51 students and 29 coaching operators	Punekar News, Oct 2026 www.punekarnews.in
"Certain political factions" (Fadnavis, 6 Oct)	UNI, 6 Oct 2026 www.uniindia.com
July: police driver video; driver removed; probe ordered	The Week, 23 Jul 2026 www.theweek.in
NCRB 2024: Maharashtra 24,171 crimes against children, highest of any state	The Hindu, 2026 www.thehindu.com
Rate 66.9 vs Madhya Pradesh 76.2 per lakh children	Deccan Herald, citing CRY, 2026 (single secondary report)